



FREE TEMPLATE • INDIE MUSIC INDIA

Music Business Plan Template, India

Instructions: Complete one plan per artist at the start of the management relationship. Review and update every 6 months. This is a working document, not a pitch deck.

Artist: _____

Manager: _____

Plan Date: _____

Review Date: _____

Section 1: The Artist

1.1 Who are they? [Write 2-3 sentences describing the artist as a musical entity. What is the sound? What is the emotional territory? Who does it remind people of, and how is it different?]

1.2 What stage are they at?

- Pre-release (no public music yet)
- Early (1-3 releases, under 5,000 monthly listeners)
- Growing (4+ releases, 5,000-50,000 monthly listeners)
- Established (50,000+ monthly listeners, regular live income)

1.3 What is genuinely good about this artist? [Not marketing language. What is the real reason someone would seek this artist out over everything else available?]

1.4 What is the honest challenge? [What is currently holding this artist back? Be specific.]

Section 2: The Market

2.1 Indian Indie Landscape India has approximately 400-500 actively releasing independent artists across genres. The domestic streaming market is enormous but per-stream rates are low (approximately USD 0.001-0.003 per stream on major platforms from Indian listeners vs. USD 0.003-0.005 from US/UK listeners). The live market in Tier 1 cities (Mumbai, Bengaluru, Delhi, Pune, Hyderabad) is the most reliable revenue source for independent artists earning below 1M monthly listeners.

2.2 Target Audience Primary audience: [Describe the most likely fan. Age range, cities, what else they listen to, how they discover music] Secondary audience: [Who else might find this

artist?]

2.3 Comparable Artists (Comps) List 3-5 artists whose career trajectory you are using as a reference point:

[e.g. Prateek Kuhad: Monthly Listeners: 2.5M Live fee range: INR 3-8L per show

Label/Independent: Independent What it tells us: Shows what's possible without a label deal]

Artist 1: Monthly Listeners: ___ Live fee range: ___ Label/Independent: ___ What the comparison tells us: ___ Artist 2: Monthly Listeners: ___ Live fee range: ___ Label/Independent: ___ What the comparison tells us: ___ Artist 3: Monthly Listeners: ___ Live fee range: ___ Label/Independent: ___ What the comparison tells us: ___

2.4 Opportunity [What is the specific opening in the market this artist can occupy? Is there a genre, language, city, or audience that is underserved?]

Section 3: Goals

3.1 12-Month Goals (be specific and measurable)

Monthly Listeners (Spotify): Current ___ / Target ___ YouTube Subscribers: Current ___ / Target ___ Instagram Followers: Current ___ / Target ___ Number of releases: ___ Number of headline shows: ___ Number of festival appearances: ___ Target monthly music income (INR): ___ Primary milestone this year: _____

3.2 3-Year Vision [What does success look like in 3 years? Describe it concretely, what the artist is releasing, where they are performing, what their income is, who knows their name.]

Section 4: Revenue Model

4.1 Current Revenue Streams Streaming royalties Monthly Average (INR): ___ Notes: ___ Live performances Monthly Average (INR): ___ Notes: ___ Brand partnerships Monthly Average (INR): ___ Notes: ___ Sync licensing Monthly Average (INR): ___ Notes: ___ Merchandise Monthly Average (INR): ___ Notes: ___ Teaching / workshops Monthly Average (INR): ___ Notes: ___ Other Monthly Average (INR): ___ Notes: ___ TOTAL Monthly Average (INR): ___

4.2 12-Month Revenue Projections Streaming royalties Monthly Target (INR): ___ Annual Target (INR): ___ How we get there: ___ Live performances Monthly Target (INR): ___ Annual Target (INR): ___ How we get there: ___ Brand partnerships Monthly Target (INR): ___ Annual Target (INR): ___ How we get there: ___ Sync licensing Monthly Target (INR): ___ Annual Target (INR): ___ How we get there: ___ Merchandise Monthly Target (INR): ___ Annual Target (INR): ___ How we get there: ___ TOTAL Monthly Target (INR): ___ Annual Target (INR): ___

4.3 Priority Revenue Focus Given the artist's current stage, which 1-2 revenue streams should be the primary focus in the next 12 months, and why? [e.g. "Live performances in Bengaluru and Pune, because the artist already has a following in these cities and has the stage presence to convert shows into word-of-mouth growth."]

Section 5: Release Strategy

5.1 Planned Releases (next 12 months) Release 1: Type: ___ Target Date: ___ Distributor: ___ Budget (INR): ___ Lead time needed: ___ Release 2: Type: ___ Target Date: ___ Distributor: ___ Budget (INR): ___ Lead time needed: ___

5.2 Distribution Current distributor: _____ Contract term ends: _____ Commission / fee structure: _____ Is this the right distributor? [] Yes [] No, reason: _____

5.3 Release Budget (per single) Recording / production Estimated Cost (INR): ___ Mixing Estimated Cost (INR): ___ Mastering Estimated Cost (INR): ___ Music video Estimated Cost (INR): ___ Photography Estimated Cost (INR): ___ PR campaign Estimated Cost (INR): ___ Paid promotion (Meta/YouTube) Estimated Cost (INR): ___ Distribution fee Estimated Cost (INR): ___ TOTAL Estimated Cost (INR): ___

Section 6: Live Strategy

6.1 Current Live Status Has the artist performed live before? [] Yes [] No Current headline fee range: INR ___ to ___ Current support act fee range: INR ___ to ___ Does the artist have a full band? [] Yes [] No, current setup: _____

6.2 Target Markets (next 12 months) City 1: Strategy: ___ Key venues / promoters: ___ Target # shows: ___ Target fee: ___ City 2: Strategy: ___ Key venues / promoters: ___ Target # shows: ___ Target fee: ___ City 3: Strategy: ___ Key venues / promoters: ___ Target # shows: ___ Target fee: ___

6.3 Festival Targets NH7 Weekender Application deadline: ___ Contact: ___ Status: ___ Magnetic Fields Application deadline: ___ Contact: ___ Status: ___ Ziro Festival Application deadline: ___ Contact: ___ Status: ___ Boxout Weekender Application deadline: ___ Contact: ___ Status: ___ [Add others] Application deadline: ___ Contact: ___ Status: ___

Section 7: Marketing And Communications

7.1 Brand Identity Visual aesthetic: _____ Tone of voice online: _____ What the artist will NOT do (boundaries): _____

7.2 Social Media Strategy Instagram Current followers: ___ Posting frequency: ___ Content focus: ___ Owner: ___ YouTube Current followers: ___ Posting frequency: ___ Content focus: ___ Owner: ___ Twitter/X Current followers: ___ Posting frequency: ___ Content focus: ___ Owner: ___ Facebook Current followers: ___ Posting frequency: ___ Content focus: ___ Owner: ___

7.3 PR Strategy Target publications: _____ PR agency engaged? [] Yes, name: ___ [] No, DIY approach: _____ Key story angles this year: _____

Section 8: Budget

8.1 Annual Operating Budget Recording and production Annual Budget (INR): ____ Marketing and promotion Annual Budget (INR): ____ PR Annual Budget (INR): ____ Live production (tech rider, travel, accommodation) Annual Budget (INR): ____ Management office costs Annual Budget (INR): ____ Legal fees Annual Budget (INR): ____ Accounting fees Annual Budget (INR): ____ Miscellaneous Annual Budget (INR): ____ TOTAL Annual Budget (INR): ____

8.2 Funding Source

- Artist self-funded
- Label advance
- Brand partnership advance
- Grant (specify): _____
- Manager co-investment
- Other: _____

Section 9: Risks And Contingencies

Artist stops releasing Likelihood (H/M/L): ____ Impact (H/M/L): ____ Mitigation: ____ Key show cancelled Likelihood (H/M/L): ____ Impact (H/M/L): ____ Mitigation: ____ Label deal collapses Likelihood (H/M/L): ____ Impact (H/M/L): ____ Mitigation: ____ Artist signs with another manager Likelihood (H/M/L): ____ Impact (H/M/L): ____ Mitigation: ____ Platform algorithm change hurts streams Likelihood (H/M/L): ____ Impact (H/M/L): ____ Mitigation: ____

Section 10: Review Log

1. Date: ____ Reviewed by: ____ Key changes made: ____ Next review date: ____

Free to use from indiemusicindia.com. Share the page, not the file.